

Axis 1visual		Axis 2operational		Axis 3language		Axis 4background noise		
Level	Key vis.	Ops	NL amb.		Distractors			Main effect
L1	large	1	exact		0			sanity check
L2	large	2	exact		0			chaining starts
L3	medium	2	paraphrase		1			near-miss zone
L4	medium	3	paraphrase		2			visual + tool-use stress
L5	small	4	compositional		3			pipeline fragility

CIPHER is not a random pile of hard samples. It is a controlled ladder: each level compounds a few specific sources of difficulty so model degradation can be interpreted instead of guessed.